and object/body placed human beings above nature. This explains the coloniser's approach to 'development' as well. Simply put, coloniality objectified nature apart from dehumanising vast swathes of humanity.[12]

Interestingly, while the Enlightenment is celebrated for ushering in the Age of Reason through its supposed challenge to Christian dogma, it is the Enlightenment whose emphasis on Christianity's Cartesian dualistic approach to humans and nature that advanced the idea of superiority of the 'rational human mind' over 'non-rational nature'. This paved the way for the conquest of nature by the 'superior' human.[13] Nature was reduced to a commodity, the knowledge of which was necessary not to live with or in it, but for the utilisation of 'natural resources'.[14] Richard Drayton, in *Nature's Government*, argued that the commodification of nature was the driving force behind imperialism and colonialism, which gave birth to capitalism and universalist developmentalism.[15] This is because, to the Christian European coloniser, the rest of the world represented 'wildness', and so he took it upon himself to 'civilise' populations and subdue nature by introducing them to 'rationality' and 'order'. This civilising mission took the form of aggressive industrialisation and spawned the development discourse which dominated the twentieth century, and continues to have contemporary purchase in several decolonised countries that are still trying to 'catch up' with the West.[16] Critically, despite the diversity of human experiences and natural conditions encountered by the coloniser in different parts of the world, he was convinced beyond doubt that the same model of economic growth, industrialisation and development could be replicated uniformly across the world without exception. This once again reflects the homogenising intent and effect of the modernity/rationality complex of European coloniality.

Raymond Murphy went so far as to say that control over nature and its utilisation as a resource may have even shaped the European coloniser's ideas on government, empire and economics since the goal was to govern all of nature. It has been posited that the very idea of rationality and its dimensions may have been the consequence of the intention to explore, exploit and govern nature in a systematic fashion, so much so that colonialism has been called the 'outworking of bureaucratic rationalisation'. Murphy argued that four dimensions of rationality became the central features of colonial States, which have been identified as follows[17]: